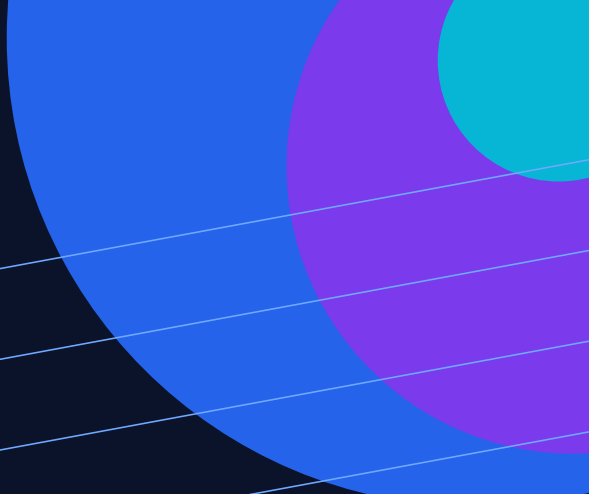




THREAT RESEARCH / DETECTION ENGINEERING

TELESHIM Feedback Scheduled Task

Campaign-specific persistence through a ten-minute task targeting ProgramData

REPORT	STATUS	CONFIDENCE
Threat-hunting dossier	Hunting query	High

Prepared for defensive research and environment-specific validation. Source facts, analytical interpretation, assumptions and proposed detection logic are intentionally separated.

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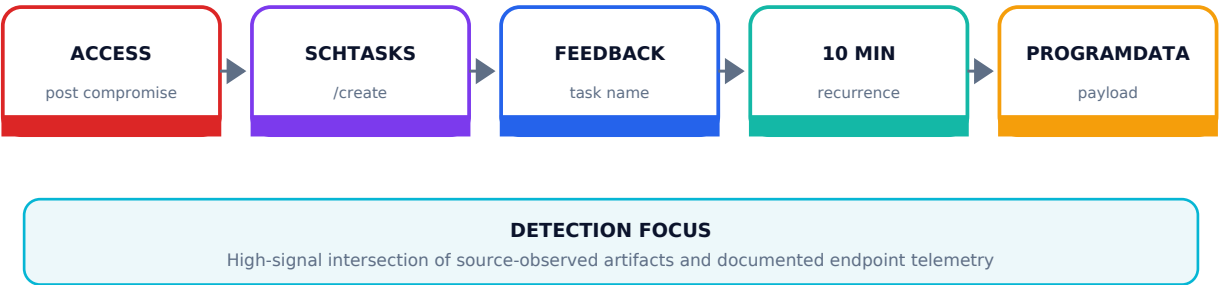
Executive Assessment

WHY THIS MATTERS

ThreatLabz captured an operator creating a task named Feedback every ten minutes to execute a payload under ProgramData. The complete combination is highly specific, but each artifact is mutable; the query is therefore retained as hunting until prevalence is measured.

Dimension	Assessment	Operational Implication
Observed behavior	schtasks /create /f /sc minute /mo 10 /tn Feedback /tr was used with a ProgramData target.	The full command construction is a strong campaign pivot.
Detection posture	Hunting query	Do not generalize to every scheduled task or ProgramData executable without additional evidence.
Telemetry	Microsoft Defender XDR DeviceProcessEvents	Captures schtasks.exe command line and initiating process.
Primary limitation	Task name, cadence and path are attacker-controlled.	Artifact changes evade this hunt; a generic alternative would be noisy.

Attack and observation flow



Evidence Model

Evidence class	Statement	Use in the package
Source fact	Zscaler ThreatLabz reports the exact Feedback task creation command and ProgramData-resident executable in captured post-compromise activity.	Directly supports the selected behavior or artifact.
Documented telemetry	DeviceProcessEvents documents process name, command line, initiating process, device/account identifiers and hash fields.	Supports the table, fields and investigation pivots.
Analytical interpretation	The complete intersection should be rare, but it remains a campaign-specific artifact rather than a durable technique-wide rule.	Defines why the intersection may be distinguishable.
Unvalidated assumption	The command line preserves switches, spacing and quoting sufficiently for contains-based matching.	Must be measured before deployment or promotion.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

The query does not detect task creation through COM/API, renamed tasks, different cadence or alternate payload locations. It is intentionally narrow.

Telemetry contract

Component	Requirement	Failure condition
Data source	Microsoft Defender XDR DeviceProcessEvents	Process creation telemetry unavailable.
Core fields	Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName, initiating-process fields, SHA1, ReportId	Command line absent or normalized beyond recognition.
Time context	Historical hunt over 90 days is recommended.	Retention is shorter than the investigated campaign window.

Detection Logic

HYPOTHESIS

Reproduction of the observed persistence should surface schtasks.exe with /create, minute cadence, modifier 10, Feedback task name and a ProgramData target.

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where FileName =~ "schtasks.exe"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/create"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/sc minute"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/mo 10"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/tn \"Feedback\""
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/tr"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains @"\"ProgramData\"
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, AccountName,
           ProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessFileName,
           InitiatingProcessCommandLine, SHA1, ReportId
```

Condition	Purpose	Durability
schtasks.exe /create	Selects command-line task creation.	High
/sc minute /mo 10	Matches the reported recurrence.	Low durability
Feedback	Matches the observed task name.	Low durability
ProgramData target	Matches the payload location family.	Medium

Analyst Triage

Priority	Question	Evidence to collect
1	What executable is passed to /tr?	Resolved path, file hash, signer, creation time.
2	Who created the task and from which parent?	Account, parent command line, remote-session context.
3	Did the task execute?	Task Scheduler events and child process telemetry.
4	Is side-loading or Telegram C2 present?	Image loads, adjacent DLLs and network events.

False-positive model

Scenario	Why it may match	Recommended handling
Updater task	Software may schedule frequent maintenance under ProgramData.	Validate publisher, software owner and stable deployment history.
Administrative automation	Scripts may use schtasks with similar switches.	Confirm change record and exact target.
Security test	Purple-team content may emulate the artifact.	Confirm authorized exercise and retain evidence.

NO PREMATURE ALLOWLISTING

Do not exclude all Feedback tasks or ProgramData targets. Validate the executable, publisher and software owner before introducing any narrow exception.

Validation Plan

Step	Action	Expected evidence
1	Search 90 days.	Distinct target paths, parents, accounts and hashes.
2	Resolve quoting variants.	Confirm contains filters cover raw command lines.
3	Correlate file and task execution.	Signer, hash and execution evidence.
4	Assess promotion value.	Low stable benign volume and campaign relevance.

Decision	Criterion
Promote / retain	Zero or a very small number of fully explainable results.
Tune	Normalize quoting only after inspecting raw events.
Reject	An authorized product uses an indistinguishable command or artifacts have no continuing value.

OPERATING NOTE

This remains hunting because specificity comes primarily from mutable campaign artifacts, not from a durable behavior invariant.

ATT&CK; Mapping & References

Technique	Relationship	Mapping posture
T1053.005 - Scheduled Task/Job	The task establishes recurring execution.	Direct behavior.
T1574.002 - DLL Side-Loading	The broader campaign uses side-loading around deployed tooling.	Supporting campaign context.

Primary and authoritative references

1. Zscaler ThreatLabz - Targeted Attack on Government Entities in the Middle East, Part 1
<https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/security-research/targeted-attack-government-entities-middle-east-part-1>
2. Microsoft Learn - DeviceProcessEvents schema
<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-deviceprocessevents-table>

DOCUMENT STATUS

Research-derived and unvalidated in the target environment. The package is suitable for controlled testing and analyst review; it is not evidence that a specific environment is compromised.